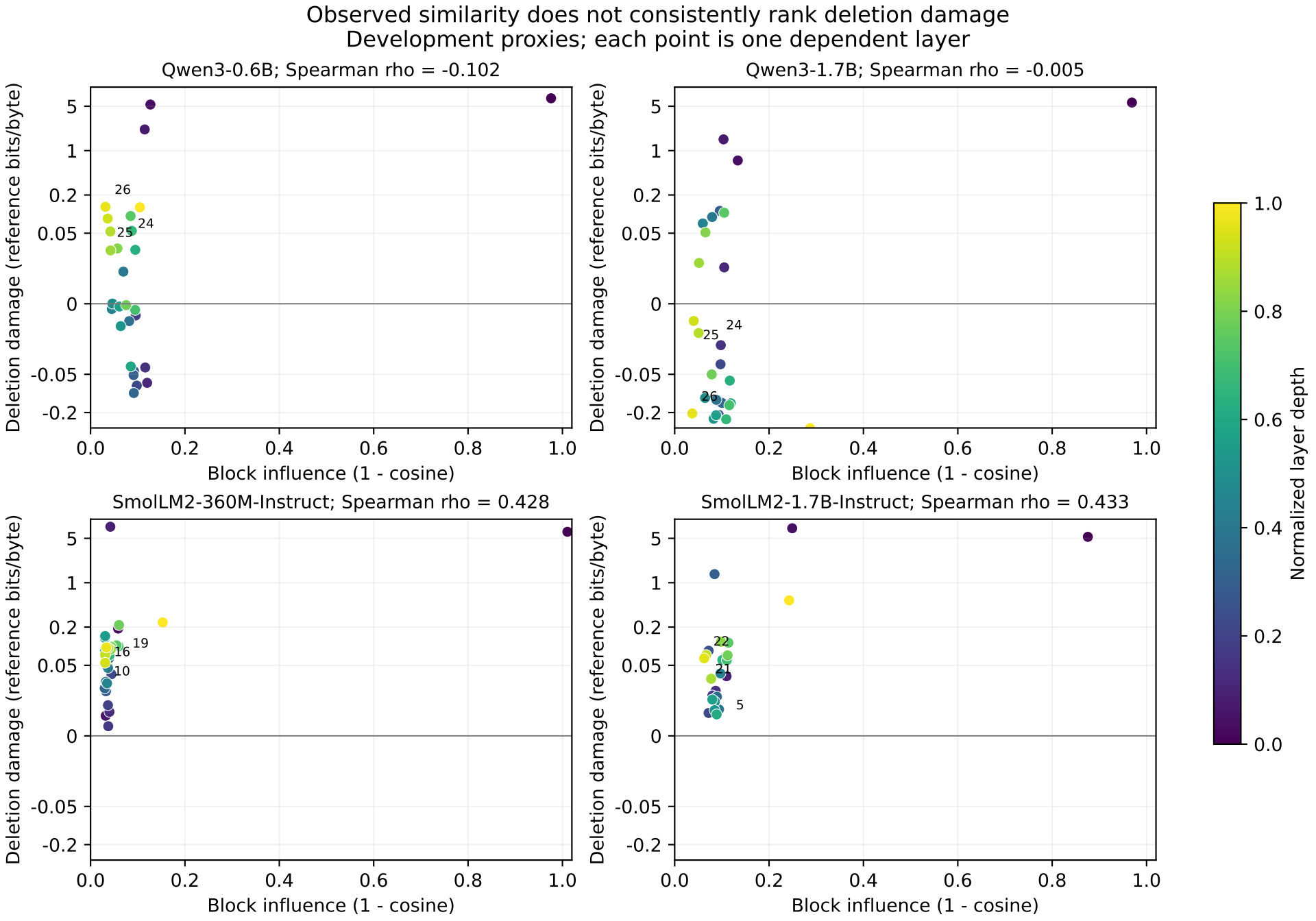
Observed similarity does not consistently rank deletion damage
Development proxies; each point is one dependent layer
Qwen3-0.6B; Spearman rho = -0.102
Qwen3-1.7B; Spearman rho = -0.005
SmolLM2-360M-Instruct; Spearman rho = 0.428
SmolLM2-1.7B-Instruct; Spearman rho = 0.433
Deletion damage (reference bits/byte)
Block influence (1 - cosine)
Normalized layer depth
5
1
0.2
0.05
0
-0.05
-0.2
0.0
0.2
0.4
0.6
0.8
1.0
26
24
25
19
16
10
22
21
5